

1 Getting Familiar

32-bit applications can address only up to 4 GB of physical RAM, whereas 64-bit applications can address as much as 16 billion GB (purely academic numbers). Both Snow Leopard and Windows 7 offers a 64-bit version on certain systems. Though a lot of Snow Leopard's inbuilt applications are 64-bit, they run quite satisfactorily even under a 32-bit install. If Apple is to be believed, every application has been re-written and revamped as a 64-bit application. The exceptions include Grapher, iTunes, DVD Player and Front Row. So now, the browser – Safari can address more memory that aids better security. Snow Leopard also has bigger, better icons. Icon View options have been stepped up with higher resolution and clarity. It also provides more control over the Sidebar, improving the Finder search facilities. Most other facilities such as iChat, PDF View, QuickTime have all undergone major improvements that improve the user experience. It also boasts of a speedier login, shutdown and network connectivity.

Please remember though that the Snow Leopard on the other hand works only on Intel systems. It needs at least 1 GB of RAM and 5 GB of free disk space.

1.2 PC or Mac?

The best part about Mac OS X Snow Leopard is the lack of choice when it comes to kits. Unlike Windows 7 which comes with a Home, Premium, Ultimate, Professional with a variety of combinations –the Mac way of handling it is pretty much simple. You buy a Mac, you get Snow Leopard along with it. The one major advantage Apple has, is that most of its hardware syncs seamlessly on its home OS as compared to others. Since both software and hardware design are part of the deal, the integration among software is better than Windows. The downside is that not all applications work on a Mac. Hence, only large makers of software actually make separate installation set-ups for Macs and PCs.

There are other factors that you need to consider while working your way around the system – from basic modifications to customising your Mac OS X experience. The article will also illustrate networking and internet browsing facilities. One of Mac's most valuable advantages is its security. There's very little malware doing the rounds that a Mac OS is vulnerable to. 